Post-service claims procedures

We will notify you of our decision within 30 days after we receive your post-service claim. If matters beyond our control require an extension of time, we may take up to an additional 15 days for review and we will notify you before the expiration of the original 30-day period. Our notice will include the circumstances underlying the request for the extension and the date when a decision is expected.

If we need an extension because we have not received necessary information from you, our notice will describe the specific information required and we will allow you up to 60 days from the receipt of the notice to provide the information.

If you do not agree with our initial decision, you may ask us to review it by following the disputed claims process detailed in Section 8 of this brochure.

Records

Keep a separate record of the medical expenses of each covered family member as deductibles and maximum allowances apply separately to each person. Save copies of all medical bills, including those you accumulate to satisfy a deductible. In most instances they will serve as evidence of your claim. We will not provide duplicate or year-end statements.

Deadline for filing your claim

Send us all of the documents for your claim as soon as possible. You must submit the claim by December 31 of the year after the year you received the service. If you could not file on time because of Government administrative operations or legal incapacity, you must submit your claim as soon as reasonably possible. Once we pay benefits, there is a three-year limitation on the re-issuance of uncashed checks.

Overseas claims

For covered services you receive by providers and facilities outside the United States and Puerto Rico, send a completed Overseas Claim Form and the itemized bills to: G.E.H.A, Medical Claims, PO Box 21172, Eagan, MN 55121. Obtain Overseas Claim Forms from geha.com/Health-Overseas-Access.

Eligibility and/or medical necessity review is required when procedures are performed, or you are admitted to a hospital outside of the United States. Review includes the procedure/service to be performed, the number of days required to treat your condition, and any other applicable benefit criteria.

If you have questions about the processing of overseas claims, contact us at 800-821-6136 or go to geha.com/My-Member-Portal. Covered providers outside the United States will be paid at the in-network level of benefits, subject to the Plan deductible, copayments and/or coinsurance. We will provide translation and currency conversion for claims for overseas (foreign) services. The conversion rate will be based on the date services were rendered.

You may be required to pay for the services at the time you receive them and then submit a claim to us for reimbursement. Proof of payment is required to be submitted with Overseas Claim Form. Canceled checks, cash register receipts, or balance due statements are not acceptable. All foreign claim payments will be made directly to the enrollee.

When members living abroad are stateside and seeking medical care, contact us at 800-821-6136, or visit geha.com/Locate-Care to locate an in-network provider. When you are seeking treatment stateside, all precertification and authorization requirements are applicable. If you utilize an out-of-network provider, out-of-network benefits would apply on the Elevate Option. The Elevate Plus Option does not provide out-of-network benefits except in cases of emergency.

Note: It is recommended that any member traveling outside the United States or territories purchase Travel Insurance.

When we need more information

Please reply promptly when we ask for additional information. We may delay processing or deny benefits for your claim if you do not respond. Our deadline for responding to your claim is stayed while we await all of the additional information needed to process your claim.

Authorized Representative

You may designate an authorized representative to act on your behalf for filing a claim or to appeal claims decisions to us. For urgent care claims, a healthcare professional with knowledge of your medical condition will be permitted to act as your authorized representative without your express consent. For the purposes of this section, we are also referring to your authorized representative when we refer to you.